> Not a poet to-day sees the color of gold;
> From the poets' band Banā'ī would get gold,
> All he will get is kīr-khar.

Shaybāni Khān had direct possession of Herī now. He took Khānzāda Khānum, Muẓaffar Mīrzā's wife. Babur has mentioned that Shaybāni did so disregarding the Muslim law.[35] Babur has denounced Shaybāni's illiteracy about Islamic law but also talks about how actually the scholars are misguided on this account as well. He instructed his own version of Qu'ran to Qāẕī Ikhtiyār and Muḥammad Mīr Yūsuf, the two well-known expert *mullās* of Herī.

It did not end here.

He took a pen and corrected the writings of Mullā Sulṭān 'Alī of Mashhad and the drawing of Bihzād. Babur has made a satirical comment in the *Baburnama* about the situation:[†]

> In a few days, Shaybāni had composed some tasteless couplet, he would have it read from the pulpit, hung in the square, and for it accept the offerings of the townspeople!

Babur has noted that Shaybāni Khān was an early riser who wouldn't miss any of the five prayers. He would recite the Qur'an with utmost glory but his acts and deeds were as absurd, impudent and heathenish as those just named.

A couple of weeks had passed since Shaybāni Khān had taken possession of Herī. He went to Pul-i-sālār and sent Tīmūr Sulṭān and 'Ubaid Sulṭān with an army against Abū'l-muḥsin Mīrzā and Kūpuk Mīrzā. Both were happily seated in Mashhad carefree and unaware of the trouble that was set to come. Both the Mirzas once thought of making the fort of Qalāt secure, but before they could act, the reaction had already occurred. The Aūzbegs were approaching. Both planned to induce a forced march against the Aūzbegs along a different route. This would have been a great idea but to their disappointment, while they remained seated in Mashhad with nothing decided, the Sulṭāns arrived.

After a bout of helplessness and cluelessness in dealing with this occasion, they decided to array the soldiers and give a fight. In the conflict, Abū'l-muḥsin Mīrzā was beaten and badly injured. Kūpuk Mīrzā charged at his brother's assailants with a handful of his men. But the Aūzbegs proved to be heftier, and they carried both brothers away. Soon the brothers were dismounted and were made to sit on the ground. Knowing well that what would follow, both embraced and kissed each other farewell. Abū'l-muḥsin showed courage by throwing a few words of hope but it didn't change the dismayed face of Kūpuk